

Data Center Workload Distribution

The table below shows approximate shares of global data center compute consumed by workload category as of 2024–2025. Figures are estimates drawn from IEA, EPRI, and Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory reports; exact values vary by source and shift as AI workloads grow.

Category	% of Total	Notes
Enterprise / Business IT	~25%	ERP, CRM, SaaS, email, internal apps; the largest legacy category, declining relative share as cloud migration continues
AI / Machine Learning	~18%	Training large models and serving inference; fastest-growing workload, up from ~10% in 2022
Video Streaming	~15%	Netflix, YouTube, TikTok, Disney+; dominated by storage I/O and transcoding at scale
Social Media	~8%	Feed ranking, content storage, ad targeting, and real-time notifications for billions of users
E-commerce / Online Retail	~6%	Transactions, inventory, logistics, recommendation engines, and fraud detection
Search Engines	~5%	Continuous web crawling, index updates, and low-latency query serving at global scale
Financial Services	~5%	Algorithmic trading, fraud detection, payment processing, and regulatory reporting
Communications	~4%	Email, video conferencing, VoIP, and messaging platforms
Gaming / Interactive Entertainment	~4%	Online game servers, cloud gaming (GeForce NOW, Xbox Cloud), and esports infrastructure
Scientific Computing / HPC	~3%	Climate simulation, genomics sequencing, drug discovery, and particle physics analysis
Government & Defense	~3%	Intelligence analysis, logistics, satellite data processing, and air-gapped classified facilities
Healthcare IT	~2%	Electronic health records, medical imaging archives, genomic databases, and clinical AI
Cybersecurity Operations	~1%	SIEM platforms, threat intelligence feeds, malware sandboxing, and SOC analytics
Misc / Other	~1%	IoT device backends, edge orchestration, DNS/PKI infrastructure, and CDN origin servers

When Claude was asked to search the web for current AI use of data centers it returned an estimate of 38% in 2026, published by ABI Research.